

“Low-cost airlines is going to be a future driver, especially for domestic travel. Some airlines may think that there is a market for premium, but largely it will be low-cost driven. Indigo’s example proves that if it is done well, it can serve customers and make the airline profitable”

KAPIL KAUL
CEO and Director, CAPA India

Kaul: In two years, the entire travel ecosystem will change. India must make full use of its highest ever airport capacities and increasing travel penetration. Two airlines having 90 per cent market share presents a challenge vis-a-vis institutional measures in terms of competition and consumer interest. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation has to be recast and the Bureau of Civil Aviation Security overhauled. There has to be more strategic competence in the regulatory and policy-making level too.
Dubey: Stress should be on maintenance in India, research in India, cargo in India and train in India, and not just on Make in India. ■

AN OCEAN OF OPPORTUNITIES

India’s 7,500-km-long coastline offers vast potential. Experts discuss how to make the best use of that geographical advantage

India has one of the highest logistics costs at 18 per cent of the country’s GDP. In an effort to mitigate that challenge, the central government is exploring waterways as an effective solution. **Bhushan Kumar**, joint secretary (SagarMala), Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, and **Rathendra Raman**, chairman, Kolkata Port Trust, discuss how Indian ports act as our gateways to the world.

THE SAGARMALA VISION

Kumar: India has a long coastline of 7,500 km with 200 ports. Of these, 80 are handling exports and imports. Making them world-class and bringing down their logistical cost is a huge challenge. To improve the quality of infrastructure, the turnaround time and to bring down the cost, the government of India launched the SagarMala project in 2015. We are working in coordination with states to improve infrastructure. There are five verticals under SagarMala.



“We are going to have a consultative panel, a maritime state development council for coordination with the states so that all stakeholders can sit together and work out a plan to improve all ports and bring in parity”

BHUSHAN KUMAR
Joint Secretary, (SagarMala), Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways